Last updated: August 27, 2026 View the latest guidelines online

Scope of the Journal

Nano Letters is a forum for reporting original results on fundamental, applied, and emerging research in all areas of nanoscience and nanotechnology that require rapid dissemination. A chief criterion to fit within the scope of *Nano Letters* is the convergence of at least two different areas or disciplines. Areas of interest to the journal include:

- Quantum, electronic, and nanophotonic materials and phenomena
- Energy conversion and storage materials and electrocatalysis
- Smart and flexible nano-electronic devices
- Nanomedicine and nano-biotechnology
- Applications of nanomaterials in living and environmental systems
- Advanced and integrated nanoscale characterization tools

Nano Letters manuscripts must be submitted through the ACS Publishing Center.

Manuscript Types

Letters (Communications)

Nano Letters is a communications journal for publishing results that need to be distributed rapidly. The preferred length for each Letter is between 1500 and 4000 words, and 3-6 figures in total, including schemes. The abstract is limited to 150 words.

Mini-Reviews

Mini-Reviews are peer-reviewed articles that highlight specific topics within nanoscience and nanotechnology. Please note: Mini-Reviews are solicited by invitation only. However, we welcome suggestions of both topics and authors, which should be sent to the Editor-in-Chief's office (eic@nanolett.acs.org). Mini-Review submissions are generally 3000-6000 words in length.

Viewpoints

Viewpoints are invited articles that are 500-1500 words in length and highlight the views of thought leaders in nanoscience. Viewpoints are intended to be forward looking and provide commentary on emerging and timely research areas. This article type is by invitation only.

Perspectives

Brief reports (1500-2000 words) that inform readers about new scientific advances in nanoscience, as reported in recently published papers in Nano Letters or other journals. Perspectives must contain a brief abstract (~120 words). Inclusion of a figure is optional. This article type is by invitation only.

Comments

Comments are brief responses to an article published in *Nano Letters*. A Comment could be a respectful presentation of alternative points of view to one that has appeared in a recent issue of the journal. The authors of the original article will be offered the opportunity to submit a response to the Comment, but the thread will be terminated at that point. Both Comments and responses to Comments are subject to critical review, and the author(s) of the original article will be invited to review the Comment and the author of the Comment will be invited to review the response.

Tutorials

Tutorials are intended to provide learners and practitioners with a brief overview and guidance on modern research topics that can be applied to the interpretation and explanation of experimental and computational data. Tutorials are by invitation only. There is no specific length requirement, but we strongly recommend that the following sections are included:

1. **Target Audience:** Start with a brief note on which fields or types of students/researchers may find this tutorial most useful.
2. **Core Principles:** Summarize key concepts or mechanisms and include intuitive explanations or simple schemes.
3. **Minimal Mathematical/physical Framework** (if applicable)**:** Offer essential equations or formalisms necessary for understanding the topic, keeping them accessible and focusing on intuition rather than exhaustive derivations.
4. **Methodological Workflow or Step-by-step Guide:** Include a simple, structured workflow (e.g., flowcharts, bullet-point procedures) that shows how a learner might practically apply the concepts from start to finish.
5. **Case Studies:** Include case studies illustrating how these principles are applied in experiments or computations.
6. **Common Pitfalls or Misunderstandings:** Highlight frequent mistakes or misconceptions that are often encountered.
7. **Outlook:** Provide a short discussion of open questions, emerging directions, or how the field is expected to evolve.

ACS Researcher Resources

While this document will provide basic information on how to prepare and submit the manuscript as well as other critical information about publishing, we also encourage authors to visit ACS Researcher Resources for additional information on everything that is needed to prepare (and review) manuscripts for ACS journals and partner journals, such as

- Mastering the Art of Scientific Publication, which shares editor tips about a variety of topics including making your paper scientifically effective, preparing excellent graphics, and writing cover letters.
- Resources on how to prepare and submit a manuscript to the ACS Publications manuscript submission and peer review system, including details on selecting the applicable Journal Publishing Agreement.
- Sharing your research with the public through the ACS Publications open access program.
- ACS Reviewer Lab, a free online course covering best practices for peer review and related ethical considerations.
- ACS Author Lab, a free online course that empowers authors to prepare and submit strong manuscripts, avoiding errors that could lead to delays in the publication process.

- ACS Inclusivity Style Guide, a guide that helps researchers communicate in ways that recognize and respect diversity in all its forms.

Manuscript Preparation

Submit with Fast Format

All ACS journals and partner journals have simplified their formatting requirements in favor of a streamlined and standardized format for an initial manuscript submission. Read more about the requirements and the benefits these serves authors and reviewers here.

Manuscripts submitted for initial consideration must adhere to these standards:

- Submissions must be complete with clearly identified standard sections used to report original research, free of annotations or highlights, and include all numbered and labeled components.
- Figures, charts, tables, schemes, and equations should be embedded in the text at the point of relevance. Separate graphics can be supplied later at revision, if necessary.
- When required by a journal's structure or length limitations, manuscript templates should be used.
- References can be provided in any style, but they must be complete, including titles. For information about the required components of different reference types, please refer to the ACS Style Quick Guide.
- Supporting Information must be submitted as a separate file(s).

Document Templates and Format

The templates facilitate the peer review process by allowing authors to place artwork and tables close to the point where they are discussed within the text. Learn more about document templates here.

General information on the preparation of manuscripts may also be found in the ACS Guide to Scholarly Communication.

Acceptable Software, File Designations, and TeX/LaTeX

See the list of Acceptable Software and appropriate File Designations to be sure your file types are compatible with the submission system. Information for manuscripts generated from TeX/LaTeX is also available.

Cover Letter

A cover letter must accompany every manuscript submission. During the submission process, you may type it or paste it into the submission system, or you may attach it as a file.

The cover letter should include the following:

- Manuscript title
- Corresponding author’s name and e-mail address
- Statement on the manuscript’s significance
- Comments on the manuscript’s novelty, impact, urgency

Please note: a clear statement of the manuscript's goals and significance is very helpful for the Editors during the pre-screening process.

Manuscript Text Components

Letters should not contain separate subsection titles but should flow continuously. The following general organization is recommended: introduction and background, integrated results and discussion, and concluding remarks. Experimental and theoretical details that are important for reproducibility, but not essential to the understanding of the Letter, should be included in the Supporting Information.

*Ethical Use of Animals or Human Participants in Research***.** For animal and human studies, the ethics committee that approved the experimental procedure must be identified and the case number provided, as described in the ACS Ethical Guidelines to Publication of Chemical Research. Research involving human participants/samples should also include a statement confirming that the samples/data were obtained through the informed consent of the donors/participants. This information should be included in the Experimental or Methods section of the manuscript.

Supporting Information

This information is provided to the reviewers during the peer-review process (for Review Only) and is available to readers of the published work (for Publication). Supporting Information must be submitted at the same time as the manuscript. See the list of Acceptable Software by File Designation and confirm that your Supporting Information is viewable.

If the manuscript is accompanied by any supporting information files for publication, these files will be made available free of charge to readers. A brief, nonsentence description of the actual contents of each file, including the file type extension, is required. This description should be labeled Supporting Information and should appear before the Acknowledgement and Reference sections. Examples of sufficient and insufficient descriptions are as follows:

Examples of sufficient descriptions: "Supporting Information: ^{1}H NMR spectra for all compounds (PDF)" or "Additional experimental details, materials, and methods, including photographs of experimental setup (DOC)".

Examples of insufficient descriptions: "Supporting Information: Figures S1-S3" or "Additional figures as mentioned in the text".

When including supporting information for review only, include copies of references that are unpublished or in-press. These files are available only to editors and reviewers.

Research Data Policy

All ACS journals strongly encourage authors to make the research data underlying their articles publicly available at the time of publication.

Nano Letters applies ACS Research Data Policy Level 1, meaning the journal encourages all authors to publicly share all the data underlying the results reported in the paper, preferably via archiving in an appropriate public repository. Authors are also encouraged to provide a Data Availability Statement describing the public availability of the data supporting the article's conclusions. Publicly available data sets should be cited appropriately.

The ACS Research Data Policy provides additional information on Data Availability Statements, Data Citation, and Data Repositories.

Language and Editing Services

A well-written paper helps share your results most clearly. ACS Publications' English Editing Service is designed to help scientists communicate their research effectively. Our subject-matter expert editors will edit your manuscript for grammar, spelling, and other language errors so your ideas are presented at their best.

Preparing Graphics

The quality of illustrations in ACS journals and partner journals depends on the quality of the original files provided by the authors. Figures are not modified or enhanced by journal production staff. All graphics must be prepared and submitted in digital format.

Graphics should be inserted into the main body whenever possible. Please see Appendix 2 for additional information.

Any graphic (figure chart, scheme, or equation) that has appeared in an earlier publication should include a credit line citing the original source. Authors are responsible for obtaining written permission to re-use this material.

Figure and Illustration Services

The impact of your research is not limited to what you can express with words. Tables and figures such as graphs, photographs, illustrations, diagrams, and other visuals can play a significant role in effectively communicating your findings. Our Artwork Editing and Graphical Abstract services generate publication-ready figures and Table of Contents (TOC) graphics that conform to your chosen journal's specifications. For figures, this includes changes to file type, resolution, color space, font, scale, line weights, and layout (to improve readability and professional appearance). For TOC graphics, our illustrators can work with a rough sketch or concept or help extract the key findings of your manuscript directly for use as a visual summary of your paper.

Preparing for Submission

Manuscripts, graphics, supporting information, and required forms, as well as manuscript revisions, must all be submitted in digital format through ACS Publishing Center, which requires an ACS ID to log in. Registering for an ACS ID is fast, free, and does not require an ACS membership. Please refer to Appendix 1 for additional information on preparing your submission

Prior Publication Policy

Nano Letters authors may deposit an initial draft of their manuscript in a preprint service. This information, along with the relevant link and date, should be stated in the cover letter. All other prior /redundant publication is forbidden.

Upon publication in *Nano Letters*, authors are advised to add a link from the preprint to the published paper via the Digital Object Identifier (DOI).

Editorial Policies

Nano Letters aims to communicate rapidly the key elements of a study that are deemed important to the scientific community. Hence, the manuscript guidelines [less than 3000 words; no more than 5 figures; abstract with no more than 150 words] must be followed. In the Cover Letter, authors are requested to provide enough background to justify the need for rapid publication of their groundbreaking results.

Appeals are reviewed at the discretion of the editorial team, with a strong commitment to fairness and transparency. While all appeals receive careful consideration, authors should be aware that only a small proportion lead to a reversal of the original editorial decision.

To initiate an appeal, the corresponding author must email a formal appeal letter to the journal's editorial office or the handling editor. The corresponding author is responsible for ensuring all authors agree to submit an appeal. Appeals should be submitted within **1 month** of receiving a decision. Your appeal letter should include:

1. Your manuscript ID
2. A clear rationale for why you disagree with the decision and include point-by-point responses to reviewer and/or editor comments
3. Evidence of any errors, potential reviewer conflicts of interest or other ethical considerations

You will receive an acknowledgement once your appeal is received. The editorial team may consult with additional editors to assess the merit of the appeal. Final decisions include upholding the original rejection, inviting a revised submission, initiating further review, or rejection with the option of transferring to another ACS journal.

Please note, only one appeal will be considered per manuscript, and all appeal decisions are final. An appeal is considered an extension of the manuscript submission process, therefore the same ACS Ethical Guidelines apply. Authors should not submit an appeal while the manuscript, or substantially similar research, is under consideration by another journal. Priority is given to active submissions under consideration. As such, decisions on appeals may take longer.

If the appeal is successful, the editorial office will provide guidance on next steps.

Providing Potential Reviewer Names

It is optional to suggest reviewers. Reviewer recommendations will be considered but cannot always be accommodated. Authors are encouraged to avoid suggesting reviewers from the authors' institutions. Do not suggest reviewers who may have a real or perceived conflict of interest. Whenever possible, suggest institutional email addresses rather than personal email addresses.

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another ACS journal or partner journal, as all the coauthors, suggested reviewers, manuscript files, and responses to submission questions are copied to the new draft submission. Authors are free to accept or decline the transfer offer.

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Publication of manuscripts on the Web may occur weeks in advance of the cover date of the issue of publication. Authors should take this into account when planning their patent and intellectual property activities related to a document and should ensure that all patent information is available at the time of first publication, whether ASAP or issue publication.

All articles published ahead of print receive a unique Digital Object Identifier (DOI) number, which is used to cite the manuscript before and after the paper appears in an issue. Additionally, any supplemental information submitted along with the manuscript will automatically be assigned a DOI and hosted on Figshare to promote open data discoverability and use of your research outputs.

ASAP Publication

Manuscripts will be published on the “ASAP Articles” page on the web as soon as page proofs are corrected and all author concerns are resolved. ASAP publication usually occurs within a few working days of receipt of page proof corrections, which can be several weeks in advance of the cover date of the issue.

Post-Publication Policies

The American Chemical Society follows guidance from the Committee on Publication Ethics (COPE) when considering any ethical concerns regarding a published article, Retractions, and Expressions of Concern.

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Additions and Corrections must be submitted as new manuscripts via the ACS Publishing Center by the Corresponding Author for publication in the "Addition/Correction" section of the Journal. The corresponding author should obtain approval from all coauthors prior to submitting or provide evidence that such approval has been solicited. The manuscript should include the original article title and author list, citation including DOI, and details of the correction.

Retractions

Articles may be retracted for scientific or ethical reasons and may be requested by the article author(s) or by the journal Editor(s), but are ultimately published at the discretion of the Editor. Articles that contain seriously flawed or erroneous data such that their findings and conclusions cannot be relied upon may be retracted in order to correct the scientific record. When an article is retracted, a notice of Retraction will be published containing information about the reason for the Retraction. The originally published article will remain online except in extraordinary circumstances (e.g. where deemed legally necessary, or if the availability of the published content poses public health risks).

Expressions of Concern

Expressions of Concern may be issued at the discretion of the Editor if:

- there is inconclusive evidence of research or publication misconduct by the authors;
- there is evidence that the findings are unreliable but the authors' institution will not investigate the case;
- an investigation into alleged misconduct related to the publication either has not been, or would not be, fair and impartial or conclusive;
- an investigation is underway but a judgment will not be available for a considerable time.

Upon completion of any related investigation, and when a final determination is made about the outcome of the article, the Expression of Concern may be replaced with a Retraction notice or Correction.

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At ACS Publications, we know it is important for you to be able to share your peer reviewed, published work with colleagues in the global community of scientists. As sharing on sites known as scholarly collaboration networks (SCNs) is becoming increasingly prevalent in today's scholarly research ecosystem, we would like to remind you of the many ways in which you, a valued ACS author, can share your published work.

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Appendix 1: PREPARING FOR SUBMISSION

We've developed ACS' publishing and editorial policies in consultation with the research communities that we serve, including authors and librarians. Browse our policies below to learn more.

Ethical Guidelines

ACS editors have provided Ethical Guidelines for persons engaged in the publication of chemical research—specifically, for editors, authors, and reviewers. Each journal also has a specific policy on prior publication.

OFAC Compliance

As a U.S.-based non-profit organization, the American Chemical Society (ACS) is required to comply with U.S. sanctions laws and regulations administered by the U.S. Treasury Department's Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC). While these laws and regulations permit U.S.-based publishers like ACS to engage in publishing-related activities with authors located in sanctioned regions in many cases, ACS may be prohibited under U.S. law from engaging in publishing-related activities in some cases, including, but not limited to, instances where an author or the institution with which an author is affiliated is located in a particular sanctioned region or has been designated by OFAC as a Specially Designated National (SDN) pursuant to certain U.S. sanctions programs. ACS reserves the right to refrain from engaging in any publishing-related activities that ACS determines in its sole discretion may be in violation of U.S. law.

Safety Considerations

Authors must emphasize any unexpected, new, and/or significant hazards or risks associated with the reported work. This information should be in the Experimental Section of a full article and included in the main text of a communication or letter. Statement examples can be found in the Safety Statement Style Sheet and additional information on communicating safety information from the *ACS Guide to Scholarly Communication* is freely available here.

Conflict of Interest Disclosure

A statement describing any financial conflicts of interest or lack thereof is published in each ACS journal and partner journal article.

During the submission process, the Corresponding Author must provide a statement on behalf of all authors of the manuscript, describing all potential sources of bias, including affiliations, funding sources, and financial or management relationships, that may constitute conflicts of interest. If the manuscript is accepted, the statement will be published in the final article.

If the manuscript is accepted and no conflict of interest has been declared, the following statement will be published in the final article: “The authors declare no competing financial interest.”

Plagiarism

In publishing only original research, ACS is committed to deterring plagiarism, including self-plagiarism. ACS Publications uses CrossCheck's iThenticate software to screen submitted manuscripts for similarity to published material. Note that your manuscript may be screened during the submission process.

Further information about plagiarism can be found in Part B of the Ethical Guidelines to Publication of Chemical Research. See also the press release regarding ACS' participation in the CrossCheck initiative.

Authorship, Author List, and Coauthor Notification

Authors are required to obtain the consent of all their coauthors prior to submitting a manuscript. The submitting author accepts the responsibility of notifying all coauthors that the manuscript is being submitted.

During manuscript submission, the submitting author must provide contact information (full name, email address, institutional affiliation, and mailing address) for all of the coauthors. Because all of the author names are automatically imported into the electronic Journal Publishing Agreement, the names must be entered into the submission system. (Note that coauthors are not required to register in the ACS Publishing Center.) Author affiliation should reflect where the work was completed, even if the author has since left that institution. Authors may include a note with a current address if their institution has changed since the work was completed.

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Criteria for authorship can be found in Part B of the Ethical Guidelines to Publication of Chemical Research. Artificial intelligence (AI) tools do not qualify for authorship. As non-person entities, these tools can neither take responsibility for published content, nor can they assent to co-authorship. The use of AI tools for text or image generation should be disclosed in the manuscript within the Acknowledgments section with a description of when and how the tools were used. For more substantial use cases or descriptions of AI tool use, authors should provide full details within the Methods or other appropriate section of the manuscript. The authors of the work are responsible for all submitted content

and agree upon submission that generated content from AI tools is appropriate, both scientifically and based on the Ethical Guidelines to Publication of Chemical Research. For more information on use of AI, please review the ACS AI Best Practices and Policy.

Any changes to the authorship after initial submission require the completion of an authorship change form. Confirmation that all authors (including those being added or removed) agree to the changes is required via the signed form. Please note that exceptions will not be made for large authorship lists and /or large numbers of changes. Authors must also provide a reason for each change and should explain how any added co-author(s) meet the authorship criteria as defined in the Ethical Guidelines to Publication of Chemical Research. Authorship changes are subject to editorial approval and insufficient and/or inappropriate reasons for changes may result in manuscript rejection. In general, the addition of new authors will be deemed inappropriate unless fully explained and justified in the context of their scientific contributions to the work. Authorship changes post-acceptance will generally not be considered except in rare circumstances with full justification. For more information, please refer to the Authorship Changes section of the Authorship Guidance & Policies.

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1. First (Given) Name Field: Enter an asterisk (*) into the "First (Given) Name" field.
2. Last (Family) Name Field: Enter your single name into the "Last (Family) Name" field.

If your paper is accepted, the asterisk (*) will be removed from the published version of the paper.

Patent Activities and Intellectual Property

Authors are responsible for ensuring that all patent activities and intellectual property issues are satisfactorily resolved prior to first publication (ASAP or in issue). Acceptance and publication will not be delayed for pending or unresolved issues of this nature.

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Diversity and Inclusion Statement

During manuscript submission, ACS journal authors have the option to submit a statement sharing information related to inclusion that is relevant for their paper. If supplying an inclusion statement, the corresponding author must provide this on behalf of all authors of the manuscript during the submission process. These statements include but are not limited to analysis of the paper’s citations and acknowledgment of indigenous land on which research was conducted. Statements expressing political beliefs are not permitted and may be removed by the journal office. All statements are subject to final review by the Editor.

- Citation Statement: The citation statement should appear in the Acknowledgements section of the manuscript. ACS recommends including the following: (1) the importance of inclusive citation practices, (2) the proportion of citations by gender and race/ethnicity for the first and last authors, (3) the method used to determine those proportions and its limitations, and (4) steps taken by the authors to mitigate citation bias in the article. (Adapted from BMES/Springer Guidelines)
- Land acknowledgment: The land acknowledgment statement should appear in the Acknowledgements section of the manuscript. The statement should link to the institutions’ formal land acknowledgments on which the research took place, if possible. Further guidance for creating these statements can be found here: https://nativegov.org/news/a-guide-to-indigenous-land-acknowledgment/.

Appendix 2: Preparing Graphics

Resolution

Digital graphics pasted into manuscripts should have the following minimum resolutions:

- Black and white line art, 1200 dpi
- Grayscale art, 600 dpi
- Color art, 300 dpi

Size

Graphics must fit a one- or two-column format. Single-column graphics can be sized up to 240 points wide (3.33 in.) and double-column graphics must be sized between 300 and 504 points (4.167 in. and 7 in.). The maximum depth for all graphics is 660 points (9.167 in.) including the caption (allow 12 pts. For each line of caption text). Lettering should be no smaller than 4.5 points in the final published format. The text should be legible when the graphic is viewed full-size. Helvetica or Arial fonts work well for lettering. Lines should be no thinner than 0.5 point.

Color

Color may be used to enhance the clarity of complex structures, figures, spectra, and schemes, etc., and color reproduction of graphics is provided at no additional cost to the author. Graphics intended to appear in black and white or grayscale should not be submitted in color.

Avoid relying on color alone to represent information. Use indicators such as symbols, text labels, or patterns to ensure the data is accessible to those with color vision deficiency or other visual conditions. If color is necessary to understand data, such as in heat maps or fluorescence images, choose accurate and accessible color combinations. For additional guidance and suggested color schemes, see How to Make Scientific Figures Accessible to Readers with Color-Blindness and Coloring Chemistry—How Mindful Color Choices Improve Chemical Communication.

Ensure the content within graphics has sufficient contrast against adjacent colors, including the background. Contrast ratios measure the difference in brightness between two adjacent colors, helping make text and images readable. The Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) define minimum contrast requirements of 4.5:1 for text and 3:1 for nontext elements, with some exceptions for elements like large text.

Two tools to measure contrast are TPGi's Colour Contrast Analyzer and Web Accessibility in Mind's Contrast Checker. To improve low contrast, increase the saturation of one of the colors, or use borders or other visual separators between adjacent colors. For additional information and examples, see Color to convey meaning and Choosing color in data visualizations in the ACS Inclusivity Style Guide.

Type of Graphics

Table of Contents (TOC)/Abstract Graphic

Consult the Guidelines for Table of Contents/Abstract Graphics for specifications.

Our team of subject-matter experts and graphical designers can also help generate a compelling TOC graphic to convey your key findings. Learn more about our Graphical Abstract service.

Figures

A caption giving the figure number and a brief description must be included below each figure. The caption should be understandable without reference to the text. It is preferable to place any key to symbols used in the artwork itself, not in the caption. Ensure that any symbols and abbreviations used in the text agree with those in the artwork.

Charts

Charts (groups of structures that do not show reactions) may have a brief caption describing their contents.

Tables

Each table must have a brief (one phrase or sentence) title that describes the contents. The title should be understandable without reference to the text. Details should be put in footnotes, not in the title. Tables

should be used when the data cannot be presented clearly in the narrative, when many numbers must be presented, or when more meaningful inter-relationships can be conveyed by the tabular format. Tables should supplement, not duplicate, information presented in the text and figures. Tables should be simple and concise, so avoid merging or splitting cells.

Schemes

Each scheme (sequences of reactions) may have a brief caption describing its contents.

Chemical Structures

Chemical structures should be produced with the use of a drawing program such as ChemDraw.

Cover Art

Nano Letters authors are encouraged to submit images to be considered for use on the journal's front cover or Supplementary Covers at the time of the submission of their revised manuscript. If your article is accepted for publication, your suggestion may also be selected for use on one of the journal's covers. Images chosen for the front cover will be published at no cost to the author.

Cover image submissions should be colorful and visually engaging, with minimal text. The cover image should not resemble a graphical abstract or data figure, but rather should be an artistic and scientifically accurate representation of the manuscript.

Image files should be submitted as TIF, JPG, PNG, or EPS files (not PDF or PPT) with a resolution of at least 300 dpi for pixel-based images. Cover art should be 8.19 inches (20.8 cm) wide × 8.05 inches (20.45 cm) high at 300 ppi, and submission of "layered" artwork is encouraged. The journal's logo will obscure the top 2.5 inches (6.35 cm) of the image. Authors should submit the cover image, along with a short (<50-word), clear legend explaining the image, as supplementary files to the ACS Publishing Center with their revised manuscript.

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